

PROJECT: "ZapPay"

A CONCEPT NOTE FOR INCUBATION & FUNDING

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1. Executive Summary

"ZapPay" is a technology startup aimed at solving the largest bottleneck at Indian petrol pumps: payment queues. We are developing an automated "Drive, Fill, Go" payment system using **Automatic Number Plate Recognition (ANPR)** technology.

- **The Problem:** Payment delays, caused by customers fumbling for cash/change or facing slow/failed QR code and card transactions, create long queues and frustrate customers.
- **The Solution:** A user links their number plate to a payment method in our app. An ANPR camera at the pump recognises the car, and the system automatically bills the user's account the moment fueling is complete. No cash, cards, or phones are required.
- **The Market:** We are targeting the **~40,000** high-traffic urban and highway petrol pumps in India, which are part of a **\$145 billion** retail fuel market.
- **The "Ask":** We are requesting admission into the IIIT NR's incubation Centre for mentorship, physical space, and project funding to build our MVP and launch a pilot.

2. The Founding Team

Our founding team consists of:

- NIDHI VAISHNAV
- PARTH BHANDAKKAR

3. The Problem We Are Solving

The primary cause of long queues at petrol pumps is not the fueling time, but the **payment transaction time**. This bottleneck is created by two main friction points:

1. **Cash Payments:** Slowed by customers counting cash and, more significantly, by attendants searching for exact change.
2. **Digital Payments:** Delayed by unreliable internet connectivity, slow QR code scanning, failed card machine transactions, or user error in the app.

This friction leads to lower efficiency for the pump owner, lost revenue (as customers leave for shorter queues), and daily frustration for drivers.

4. Our Solution: "ZapPay"

Our solution eliminates the payment step entirely, creating a seamless "Drive, Fill, Go" experience.

The SmartFuel system connects a user's registered vehicle number plate to their preferred payment method via our secure mobile app. When a registered user drives into a partner pump, our system automatically verifies the vehicle using ANPR technology. Once fueling is complete, the payment is processed instantly and automatically from the user's account, allowing them to leave immediately with a digital receipt.

5. Technology & Innovation

Our key innovation is **automation**. While current competitors (like QR codes) offer digital payment, they are still fundamentally manual processes that require user action. We are the first to offer a truly automated, invisible payment experience for fuel, much like FASTag did for highway tolls. Our system is built on a robust stack of modern AI, mobile, and cloud technologies.

6. Market Opportunity & Business Model

- **Market Opportunity:** We are targeting the Indian retail fuel market, a multi-billion dollar industry. Our initial serviceable market is the thousands of high-traffic urban and highway pumps where our solution provides maximum value. Market data shows a high, and growing, adoption of digital payments at these pumps, but the *method* (QR, Card) is slow and inefficient.
- **The Customer (B2B):** Our customer is the petrol pump owner, who operates on razor-thin profit margins. They cannot compete on price. Their only path to growth is increasing sales volume by reducing queue times. Our system is a high-ROI solution that directly enables this.
- **Business Model & Revenue Streams:** Our app will be free for drivers to ensure rapid adoption. We will generate revenue from pump owners through a B2B model:
 1. A one-time setup and hardware installation fee.
 2. A recurring monthly subscription (SaaS) fee for software and support.
 3. A small, per-transaction processing fee.

7. Current Status & Project Plan

We are currently at the **Concept & MVP Planning** stage. We have validated the idea, finalized the business model, and are ready to begin development. We have a clear 6-month plan.

- **Month 1-2:** Register "ZapPay Technologies Pvt. Ltd." & build the software-only MVP (using a simple webcam).
- **Month 3:** Procure professional ANPR hardware and integrate it with our software. Secure a "Letter of Intent" from a local petrol pump for a pilot test.
- **Month 4-6:** Deploy the full system at our first pilot location, test rigorously, and gather data on transaction speed and user feedback.

8. Our Request

To achieve the plan outlined above, we are requesting formal admission into the IIITNR Incubation Center.

We are seeking holistic support from the college to turn this concept into a reality. This includes:

- **Mentorship:** Critical guidance from faculty and industry mentors on B2B sales, hardware integration, and financial planning.
- **Project Funding:** We are also seeking financial support from the college to fund our initial development, including company registration, hardware for our pilot, and other foundational expenses.
- **Resources:** Access to college labs (if needed for testing) and a formal platform to connect with other entrepreneurs.

We are confident that with the mentorship and support of the Incubation Center, we can turn “ZapPay” from an idea into a successful, scalable, and impactful company.

Thank you for your time and consideration.